

IN CONTEXT

Salzburg

In Mozart's day, the city of Salzburg was ruled by its archbishop as an independent state, although it was part of the wider Hapsburg-ruled Holy Roman Empire, with its capital at Vienna. With a population of less than 20,000, the city supported elaborate court and ecclesiastical life and was embellished with fine Baroque architecture. Despite its many splendors, Mozart despised Salzburg as a backwater, deriding its court musicians as "coarse, slovenly, dissolute." In 1803, the city lost its independence and eventually became part of Austria.



SALZBURG BENEATH THE GREEN DOMES OF
ITS BAROQUE CATHEDRAL

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart was born in Salzburg on January 27, 1756. His father, Leopold, was employed as a musician at the court of Salzburg's ruling prince-archbishop. Leopold was a